

# Masking-Tape Letter Roads

Where: Living room · Time: 20 min · Ages 3–5

## You need

- Masking tape or painter's tape
- Toy cars

## Steps

1. Tape a giant letter on the floor (start with the first letter of your child's name).
2. Drive a toy car along the letter, saying its sound: 'mmm' for M.
3. Add more letters to make a road map. Can they drive to the letter that says 'sss'?
4. Peel the tape off; it won't mark the tiles.

Reading tip: Say the sound, not the letter name: 'buh', not 'bee'.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Lift & Lobby Reading Hunt

Where: Your building · Time: 10 min · Ages 3–8

## You need

- Your eyes!
- Optional: the printable hunt list

## Steps

1. In the lift, ask your child to find and press your floor number.
2. Spot letters on signs: EXIT, PUSH, PULL, LOBBY, G for ground.
3. Older kids can read the whole sign and tell you what it means.
4. Give one point per word read and celebrate at the door!

Reading tip: Real-world signs show children that reading is useful everywhere.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Frozen Letter Rescue

Where: Kitchen or balcony · Time: 30 min (plus freezing) · Ages 3–6

## You need

- Plastic tub
- Foam or magnetic letters
- Water
- Salt
- Squeeze bottle of warm water

## Steps

1. The night before, freeze some letters in a tub of water.
2. Pop the ice block onto a tray. Sprinkle salt and squirt warm water to melt it.
3. As each letter is rescued, say its sound and think of a word that starts with it.
4. Can you build a word with the rescued letters?

Reading tip: A perfect cool-down for a hot Dubai afternoon.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Pillow-Fort Reading Den

Where: Living room · Time: As long as you like · Ages 3–8

## You need

- Cushions, sheets, clothes pegs
- A torch
- Favourite books

## Steps

1. Build a cosy fort together using the sofa and dining chairs.
2. Switch off the lights and read inside by torchlight.
3. Take turns: you read a page, then your child reads a word or a page.
4. Make a 'Den Rules' sign and let your child write it.

Reading tip: Shared reading in a special place builds a love of books.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Sand-Tray Writing

Where: Balcony or table · Time: 15 min · Ages 3–6

## You need

- A baking tray
- Beach sand, salt or semolina
- A paintbrush

## Steps

1. Bring a little sand back from your next beach trip (or use salt).
2. Spread it in the tray. Say a sound and write the letter with a finger.
3. Shake the tray gently to 'erase', then try the next one.
4. Older kids can write short words like cat, sun or map.

Reading tip: Feeling letters with fingers helps them stick in memory.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Supermarket Word Detectives

Where: Supermarket · Time: During shopping · Ages 4–8

## You need

- A shopping list written in big, clear letters
- A pencil

## Steps

1. Write a short list together at home: milk, eggs, apples, bread.
2. At the shop, your child reads each item and finds it.
3. Look for the matching word on the packet and tick it off.
4. Bonus: find something that starts with 'b'.

Reading tip: Choose 3–5 items for younger readers, more for older ones.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Grow a Balcony Herb Garden

Where: Balcony or windowsill · Time: 15 min, then daily · Ages 3–8

## You need

- Small pots
- Soil
- Mint or basil cuttings
- Lolly sticks and a marker

## Steps

1. Plant the cuttings together and water them.
2. Write plant labels on lolly sticks: MINT, BASIL.
3. Keep a 'plant diary': draw and write one word each day (tall, green, new leaf).
4. Pick some mint for a fresh drink.

Reading tip: Indoor shade in summer, balcony sun in winter.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Paper Lantern (Fanoos) Craft

Where: Table · Time: 30 min · Ages 4–8

## You need

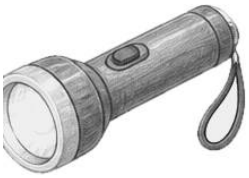
- Coloured card
- Scissors
- Glue or tape
- Battery tea-light

## Steps

1. Fold a card in half the long way and cut slits from the fold, stopping 2 cm from the edge.
2. Unfold, roll into a tube, and tape the ends. Add a handle strip.
3. Write a kind word on it: love, kind, share, friend.
4. Read 'Noor and the Neighbours' by lantern light, then gift one to a neighbour!

Reading tip: Great for Ramadan, Eid, Diwali or any special night.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Shadow-Puppet Theatre

Where: Bedroom wall · Time: 30 min · Ages 3–8

## You need

- Black card
- Scissors
- Lolly sticks or straws
- A torch or phone light

## Steps

1. Draw and cut out characters from a story: three pigs and a wolf, or a lion and a mouse.
2. Tape each one onto a stick.
3. Darken the room and shine the torch at the wall.
4. Retell the story together. Your child can be the narrator!

Reading tip: Retelling stories builds understanding and vocabulary.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Bath-Time Foam Letters

Where: Bathroom · Time: 10 min · Ages 3–6

## You need

- Bath foam or plain shaving foam
- Bath tiles

## Steps

1. Squirt foam onto the bath tiles and spread it flat.
2. Write a letter or word with a finger and ask your child to read it.
3. Swap: your child writes and you read.
4. Wipe away and start again.

Reading tip: Keep it playful. Mistakes simply wipe away!

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Make a Mini Book

Where: Table · Time: 30 min · Ages 4–8

## You need

- One sheet of A4 paper
- Scissors
- Crayons

## Steps

1. Fold the paper into 8 squares, cut the middle slit, and fold it into a little book.
2. Write a title together, for example 'My Day in Dubai'.
3. Your child draws one picture per page and writes (or tells you) a sentence.
4. Read the finished book at bedtime.

Reading tip: Children love reading words they wrote themselves.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Float-a-Dhow Bath Boats

Where: Bathroom or kitchen sink · Time: 20 min · Ages 3–7

## You need

- Clean juice cartons or sponges
- Straws
- Paper sails
- Tape

## Steps

1. Make a boat from a carton or sponge with a straw mast and a paper sail.
2. Write a word on each sail: sun, sea, fish.
3. Float them and read each boat's name as it 'docks'.
4. Talk about the old dhows at Dubai Creek.

Reading tip: Ask: Will it float or sink? Why?

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Hallway Word Obstacle Course

Where: Hallway or living room · Time: 20 min · Ages 4–8

## You need

- Paper cards
- Marker
- Cushions

## Steps

1. Write action words on cards: hop, jump, crawl, spin, run.
2. Place them along a course of cushions.
3. Your child reads each card and does the action.
4. Mix in sight words for extra practice.

Reading tip: Burns energy indoors when it's too hot outside.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Weekend Outing Story Hunt

Where: Park, beach or desert (cooler months) · Time: Outing · Ages 3–8

## You need

- Phone camera
- A small notebook

## Steps

1. On a park, beach or desert trip, take 5 photos: a palm tree, a shell, sand, a bird, a camel.
2. At home, print or look at the photos together.
3. Your child tells a story using the photos, and you write it down.
4. Read the story back together. Add it to your Mini Book!

Reading tip: Best from October to April, early in the morning.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Snack-Time Sound Sort

Where: Kitchen · Time: 10 min · Ages 3–5

## You need

- Small snacks: dates, grapes, apple slices, bread, crackers
- Two plates labelled with letters

## Steps

1. Label one plate 'd' and one plate 'g'.
2. Say each snack's name: 'dates' starts with 'duh', so it goes on the d plate!
3. Try new letters: a for apple, b for bread.
4. Eat the snacks when the sorting is done!

Reading tip: Hearing first sounds is the first step to reading.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆



# Bedtime Gratitude Jar

Where: Bedroom · Time: 5 min nightly · Ages 3–8

## You need

- A clean jar
- Small paper strips
- A pencil

## Steps

1. Each night, share one happy thing from the day.
2. Write it on a strip (younger ones can draw). Older kids write it themselves.
3. Fold it and pop it into the jar.
4. At the end of the month, read them all together.

Reading tip: A calm, positive way to end the day, just like Ollie Owl.

We did it on: _____ ☆ ☆ ☆